

NovaCart

Customer Support & Escalation Policy

Ticket creation, priority, normal conversation and human escalation rules

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1. Purpose

This policy defines how NovaCart customer support should handle normal conversations, support issues, ticket creation, priority classification, and human escalation.

Its most important rule is that a normal conversation must not automatically generate a ticket. Tickets are created when a customer has a support issue that requires tracking, investigation, action, or human involvement.

2. Normal Conversation vs Support Issue

A normal conversation includes greetings, casual questions, general product information, and simple policy explanations that can be answered from the knowledge base.

Examples:

- “Hello.”
- “How are you?”
- “What does shipped mean?”
- “How can I return an eligible product?”

These should normally return an answer with **ticket_created = false**.

A support issue is a problem requiring investigation, an action, a transaction check, or case tracking. These may create a ticket.

3. Ticket Creation Principle

The system should first detect intent and determine whether a ticket is required.

Conceptually:

- Detect intent.
- Determine whether the message is a support issue.
- If no ticket is required, answer normally.
- If a ticket is required, determine priority.
- Create the ticket with the detected intent, priority, description, and customer reference.

- Escalate to a human when the issue requires investigation or authority beyond the AI assistant.

4. Ticket Should NOT Be Created For Normal Chat

The Copilot must avoid unnecessary ticket creation.

No ticket should normally be created for:

- Greetings.
- Thank-you messages.
- Casual conversation.
- General FAQs.
- Simple policy explanations.
- Basic product information.
- Basic order-status explanations when no investigation is required.

Example:

Customer: "Hello, how are you?"

Expected: Friendly response, **ticket_created = false**.

5. Support Issue Categories

Common support intents include:

- Payment issue.
- Refund issue.
- Return issue.
- Cancellation issue.
- Shipping or delivery issue.
- Product/order issue.
- Account issue.
- Complaint.
- Technical support issue.
- Other issue requiring investigation.

The intent should represent the primary customer problem rather than simply repeating a keyword from the message.

6. Priority Classification

Priority should normally be determined by the system using the intent, severity, customer impact, urgency, and available evidence.

Recommended levels:

- Low — informational or minor issue with little immediate impact.
- Medium — issue requires action or investigation but is not critical.
- High — significant financial, order, delivery, or customer-impact issue requiring timely attention.

- Critical — severe security, widespread service, or urgent risk requiring immediate human attention.

The customer does not need to manually select the priority in normal operation.

7. Low Priority Examples

Typical low-priority cases include:

- General product questions.
- Non-urgent information requests.
- Basic policy clarification.
- Minor questions with no transaction impact.

These may not require a ticket at all if they can be resolved directly.

8. Medium Priority Examples

Typical medium-priority cases include:

- Order modification requiring verification.
- Delayed delivery that needs investigation.
- Return eligibility dispute.
- Non-urgent product issue.
- Account issue without immediate security risk.

The final priority should depend on the actual impact and available information.

9. High Priority Examples

Typical high-priority cases include:

- Payment deducted but order not confirmed.
- Refund expected but unresolved after the applicable process.
- Significant delivery failure involving a paid order.
- Repeated failed resolution attempts.
- Serious customer-impacting order issue.

Example:

Customer: "My payment was deducted but my order was not confirmed."

Expected intent: payment_issue.

Expected handling: create a ticket when transaction verification is required and assign high priority.

10. Critical Escalation

Critical escalation should be reserved for situations such as:

- Suspected account takeover or serious security compromise.
- Widespread system failures affecting many customers.
- Severe safety concerns.
- Other situations requiring immediate authorized human intervention.

The AI assistant should not label a case critical merely because the customer is angry.

11. Payment Issues

Payment issues may include:

- Payment deducted but order not confirmed.
- Payment failed after money appears to be deducted.
- Duplicate payment.
- Incorrect payment status.
- Payment reconciliation problem.

The assistant should collect appropriate non-sensitive transaction information and escalate when system verification is required.

Never request passwords, OTPs, PINs, or full confidential payment credentials.

12. Refund Issues

Refund issues may include:

- Refund not received.
- Refund status unclear.
- Refund amount disputed.
- Refund initiated but not completed.
- Customer disputes refund eligibility.

The assistant should distinguish between “refund requested,” “refund initiated,” and “refund completed.” It should never claim that a refund is complete without verified information.

13. Return Issues

Return-related escalation may include:

- Return request rejected.
- Damaged product requiring evidence review.
- Wrong product received.
- Return pickup failure.
- Return inspection dispute.
- Customer disputes return eligibility.

Simple return-policy questions can be answered without creating a ticket.

14. Delivery Issues

Delivery escalation may include:

- Package marked delivered but not received.
- Shipment appears lost.
- Tracking has stopped progressing.
- Wrong delivery location.

- Repeated failed delivery attempts.
- Damaged shipment requiring investigation.

Simple tracking questions should normally not create a ticket.

15. Account and Security Issues

Account issues may include login problems, missing orders, suspicious account activity, or unauthorized access concerns.

Security-related issues should be escalated when identity verification, account recovery, or security investigation is required.

The AI assistant must never request confidential authentication secrets.

16. Angry or Frustrated Customers

Customer emotion alone should not automatically determine ticket priority.

For example:

Customer: "This is so frustrating! How do I track my order?"

Expected handling: Answer the tracking question; do not create a ticket merely because the customer is frustrated.

However, if the customer is frustrated because a serious unresolved issue exists, the underlying issue should determine the priority and escalation path.

17. Missing Information

If required information is missing, the assistant should ask concise follow-up questions instead of guessing.

For example, for a payment issue the assistant may request an order number or transaction reference.

The assistant should request only information necessary to resolve the issue and should avoid sensitive credentials.

18. AI Must Not Guess

The Copilot must not invent:

- Refund status.
- Order confirmation.
- Delivery date.
- Restock date.
- Policy exceptions.
- Payment success.
- Internal investigation results.
- Human-agent decisions.

When approved knowledge or system data is insufficient, the assistant should clearly state the limitation and escalate when appropriate.

19. Ticket Information

A ticket should contain useful structured information such as:

- Customer ID.

- Intent.
- Subject.
- Customer message/description.
- Priority.
- Status.
- Creation timestamp.
- Escalation reason when applicable.

The ticket should contain enough information for a human agent to understand the issue without requiring the customer to repeat everything unnecessarily.

20. Ticket Status

Recommended ticket statuses include:

- Open — issue has been created and requires attention.
- In Progress — an agent or system is actively working on it.
- Waiting for Customer — additional customer information is required.
- Resolved — issue has been resolved.
- Closed — ticket is completed and no further action is expected.

The exact implementation may vary according to the application's database model.

21. Human Escalation Rules

Human escalation is appropriate when:

- Internal records must be checked.
- A financial transaction requires reconciliation.
- A policy exception is requested.
- The customer disputes an automated decision.
- A security issue requires verification.
- The AI cannot confidently determine the correct resolution.
- Multiple systems show conflicting information.
- The issue has significant customer impact.

22. Resolution Without Ticket

The Copilot should prefer direct resolution when the answer is available in the approved knowledge base and no system action is required.

Examples:

Customer: "What is your return window?"

Expected: Explain the approved return window. No ticket.

Customer: "Can I cancel before shipment?"

Expected: Explain the cancellation policy. No ticket unless the customer asks for an actual cancellation requiring order action.

23. Examples

Example 1 — Normal chat:

Customer: "Hello."

Expected: Friendly response; no ticket.

Example 2 — General FAQ:

Customer: "What is your return policy?"

Expected: Retrieve the Return Policy and answer; no ticket.

Example 3 — Payment problem:

Customer: "My payment was deducted but my order was not confirmed."

Expected: payment_issue, high priority, ticket creation when verification is required.

Example 4 — Delivery delay:

Customer: "My order is two days late and tracking hasn't changed."

Expected: shipping/delivery issue, medium or high priority depending on impact and system evidence, ticket if investigation is required.

Example 5 — Angry but informational:

Customer: "I'm really annoyed! What does 'shipped' mean?"

Expected: Explain the status; no ticket.

24. Final Decision Rule

The Copilot should follow this sequence:

1. Understand the customer's message.
2. Detect the primary intent.
3. Decide whether it is normal conversation or a support issue.
4. If normal conversation, answer without creating a ticket.
5. If it is a support issue, determine severity and priority.
6. Create a ticket when tracking or investigation is required.
7. Escalate to a human when the AI lacks authority, information, or confidence.
8. Never invent an outcome or promise an unsupported resolution.

25. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative source for general customer-support ticket and escalation behavior in the NovaCart Autonomous Customer Support Copilot.

Specialized policies such as Payment, Refund, Return, Cancellation, Shipping & Delivery, and Product & Order should be retrieved for issue-specific answers.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.